

tion—that means passion for brands, consumers and seeing your brands in the stores. It applies to everything we do and the need to be absolutely single-minded. Then, there is the part on science being a differentiator. That means there is a need to think short-term and long-term and also bring the two together. The third is getting back to the centre of the business. In five years, we must show clear results on sustainability with impact that is very visible. Finally, Danone should have the best talent across functions with a strong culture bordering on passion for performance.

Q: What do you like about the Indian market?

A: India is a combination of extraordinarily sophisticated facets. There is a lot of science plus history that is ancient and also young. All that makes it a very fascinating and energising place to do business.

Q: What makes India difficult to crack?

A: There is never an easy market. One must be patient. We have an infant nutrition portfolio and one that is very sophisticated. India gives us many options here and our expertise with science has to be at the core of it.

34 | There are a large number of children born every year and we believe we can make a difference to the life of the mother and baby. There is Protinex, a brand that is old and iconic, but a lot more can be done with it. There are not many companies that have the science that we have when it comes to infant nutrition. At the end of it, it is about leveraging your portfolio to make it relevant and India, to that extent, is no different except that the size of the opportunity is much bigger, and the market is growing fast!

Q: As you look at the markets that you operate in, which one does India remind you of?

A: The two markets that have elements of resemblance are China and Indonesia... China for the extreme sophistication of the consumer plus the role of digital. In Indonesia, there are a set of requirements and whatever you do, you must be at the right price points. Besides, some of the logistics constraints there are more challenging than in India. To that extent, India is a mix of both China and Indonesia and that is one of the many reasons that makes it both unique and exciting.

Q: What do you have to say about Danone's presence in India today?

A: We are not at the scale that we should be in India... India needs to be in Danone what it is to the scale of the world... the question is how fast that can be done. If we want to be a global nutrition leader, we must be big in



India... Look at the size of the market and opportunity, the importance of the market, its sophistication and, therefore, what the market can bring to us. Danone India [needs to] become a source of talent to Danone in the rest of the world.

Q: Historically, French companies have a thrust on R&D and demonstrate a lot of patience...

A: I will agree on the science part and yes, we are here for the long-term. But patience cannot be an excuse for going slow. I would go with a good mix of patience and impatience. Danone looks at India with a clear strategic approach. If you look at the US and China, they are our Top 2 markets, followed by France and that is a clear reflection of their economic size. In India, we acquired key businesses (in August 2011, it bought Wockhardt's nutrition business for ₹1,575 crore and with it came brands such as Farex, Dexolac, Nusobee and Protinex).

Q: Does that mean there is enough growth from the organic and inorganic routes here?

A: We are only scratching the surface in India. The question is really about how many newborns are being fed with our products? We can do a lot more. Look at Protinex... There are going to be over 300-400 million people in the 65+ age group by 2030. That tells you how large adult medical nutrition is. The portfolio is there but execution needs to be very good. Perhaps, I may not need to go out and buy something.

Q: Danone had a presence in the dairy business earlier. Do you want to look at it again?

A: I am a businessperson and will never say no to